

Phase 1: Foundation and Quick Wins

Day 3 - Copilot Studio Core



Objectives

- Explain what Copilot Studio is and how the modern authoring experience works
- Introduce Skills as reusable, markdown-based instructions
- Test, publish, and connect an agent to channels
- Describe agents, knowledge sources, and generative answers
- Navigate the workflow designer and basic actions
- Apply responsible and secure agent design basics



SESSION 1

Understanding Copilot Studio

What agents are, what they know, and how they answer

What Is Copilot Studio?

SETTING THE STAGE

A low-code platform for building custom AI agents - grounded in your own knowledge, connected to your systems, and published wherever your people already work.

- Sits between ready-made Copilot and full custom development
- One workspace covers authoring, testing, publishing, and analytics
- Built for makers and IT alike - no data science background required

The Modern Authoring Experience

HOW YOU BUILD



Natural-Language Authoring

Describe what you want in plain language and Copilot Studio drafts a starting point.



Low-Code Canvas

Visually arrange topics, actions, and conversation flow - no coding required.



Templates & Connectors

Start from prebuilt templates and connect directly to your existing systems.

Anatomy of an Agent

THE BUILDING BLOCKS

Every agent in Copilot Studio is built from the same four core pieces.



Knowledge Sources

WHAT YOUR AGENT KNOWS



Documents

PDFs, Word docs & files you upload directly



Websites

Public or internal web pages the agent can search



Dataverse & Tables

Structured business data connected directly



Public Content

Broader web knowledge when appropriate

Generative Answers: How It Works

GROUNDED RESPONSES

The same grounding pattern from Day 1's RAG discussion, built directly into your agent.



Question

A person asks the agent something

→



Search Knowledge

Agent searches its connected sources

→



Ground Response

Relevant content is added to context

→



Generate Answer

A grounded, cited answer is returned

Understanding Copilot Studio Recap

WRAP-UP

- Copilot Studio is a low-code platform for building custom agents
- Natural-language authoring and a visual canvas make building approachable
- Every agent combines topics, knowledge, actions & channels
- Knowledge sources range from documents to structured data
- Generative answers ground responses in real, connected content
- The payoff: consistent answers, freed-up teams, always-on support



SESSION 2

Building & Publishing Agents

From skills and workflows to testing, publishing, and channels

Topics: The Conversation Building Blocks

STRUCTURING CONVERSATIONS



A Topic defines what your agent can talk about - pairing trigger phrases with a response or action.



Trigger phrases tell the agent when a topic applies



Conversation nodes guide multi-step interactions



Escalation paths hand off to a human when needed

Designing for a Great Conversation

CRAFT TIPS

- Keep each topic focused on one clear task
- Write natural trigger phrases the way real users type
- Always provide a path to a human for edge cases
- Handle “I don't know” gracefully instead of guessing

Introduction to Skills (Markdown-Based)

REUSABLE INSTRUCTIONS

A Skill is a reusable set of instructions, written in markdown, that tells an agent exactly how to handle a task.

- Reusable across multiple topics and agents
- Version-controlled and easy to update
- Keeps complex logic readable for non-developers

```
# Skill: Reset Password

## Instructions

- Verify the user's identity

- Trigger the reset workflow

- Confirm completion clearly

## Escalate if unresolved
```

The Workflow Designer

VISUALIZING THE LOGIC

Every conversation follows a simple pattern you can see and edit visually.



Trigger

A phrase or event starts the topic



Condition

The flow branches based on context



Action

The agent calls a system or flow



Response

The agent replies or asks a question

Common Actions & Building Blocks

WHAT AGENTS CAN DO

Call an API

Reach out to an external service for data

Ask a Question

Collect information needed to continue

Condition / Branch

Route the conversation based on logic

Trigger Power Automate

Kick off a flow in your existing systems

Send a Message

Reply with text, cards, or rich content

Create or Update a Record

Write information back to a data source

From Build to Launch: Testing & Publishing

GETTING TO LAUNCH

A short, repeatable cycle keeps quality high before - and after - launch.



Build

Author topics, knowledge & actions



Test

Try real conversations in the test pane



Publish

Push the agent live to production



Monitor

Review analytics and refine over time

Where Agents Live: Publishing Channels

MEET PEOPLE WHERE THEY ARE



Responsible & Secure Agent Design Basics

BUILDING IT RIGHT

- Limit the agent's scope to what it's meant to do
- Keep a human-in-the-loop for sensitive actions
- Control what data and systems the agent can access
- Apply content moderation to inputs and outputs

Common Copilot Studio Use Cases

WHERE AGENTS ADD VALUE

IT Helpdesk

Password resets & common tickets

HR Onboarding

Guides new hires through day one

Sales Assistant

Product & live pricing questions

Customer FAQ

Instant answers, day or night

Internal Knowledge Search

Finds answers across documents

Order Status Lookup

Connects to live order systems

Copilot Studio in Action

A CLOSER LOOK



IT Helpdesk Agent

Resolves password resets and common tickets instantly, escalating complex issues to a human.



HR Onboarding Agent

Guides new hires through paperwork, benefits, and policy questions from day one.



Sales Assistant Agent

Answers product questions and pulls live pricing from connected systems.

Building & Publishing Recap

WRAP-UP

Topics pair trigger phrases with a response or action

Skills package reusable instructions in readable markdown

The workflow designer visualizes trigger → condition → action → response

Actions connect agents to APIs, flows, and your own data

Build, test, publish, monitor - a repeatable launch cycle

Responsible design basics carry Day 2's principles into every agent


THANK YOU